



Automatic Gain Control (AGC)

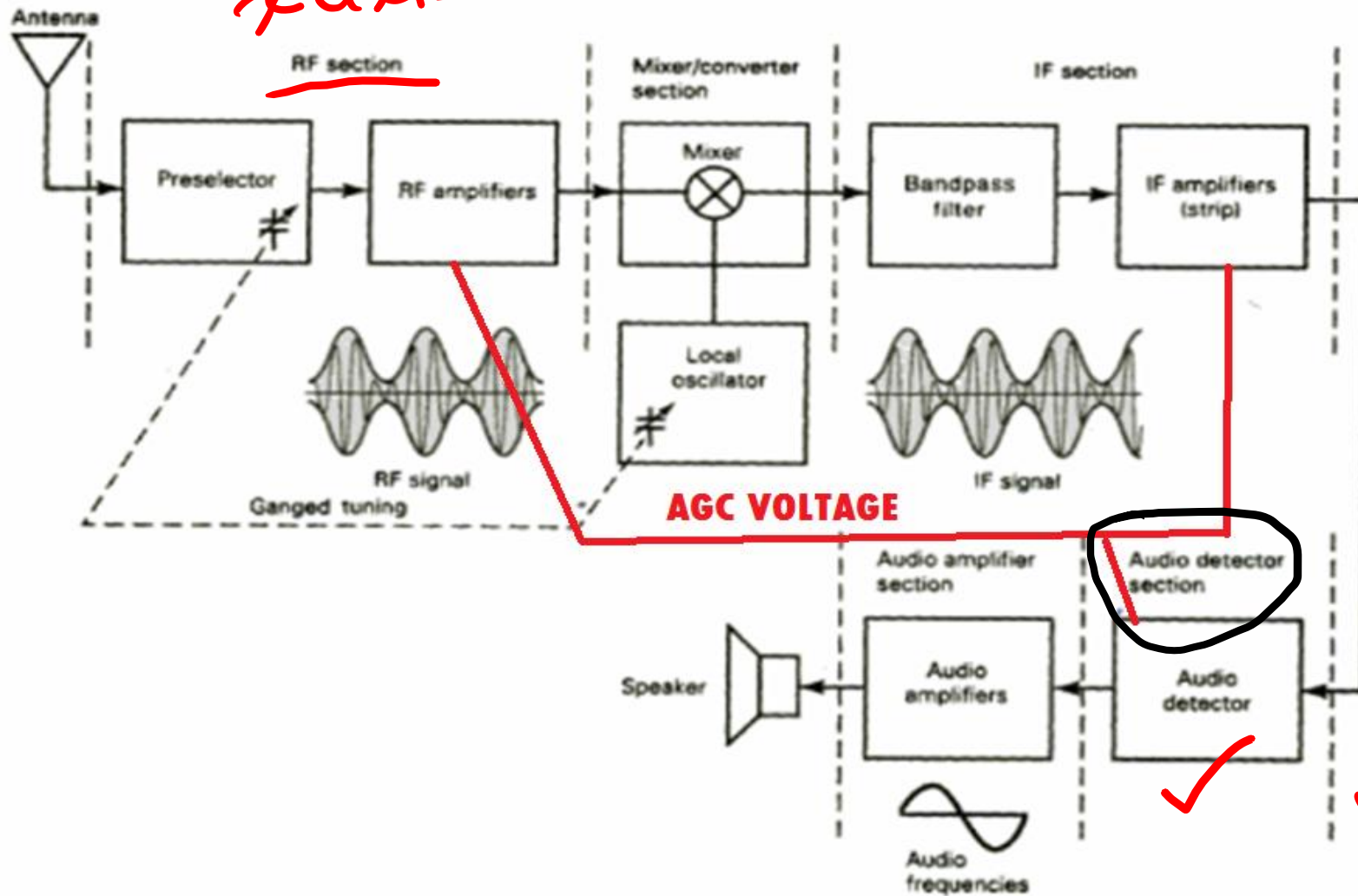
Complied By:
Kartik R. Patel
EXTC Department
KJSSE, SVU

Basic Principle

- An AGC circuit **compensates for minor** variations in the received RF signal level.
- It automatically **increases** receiver gain for **weak** RF input levels
- And automatically **decrease** the receiver gain when **strong** RF signal is received.

Receiver with AGC

x axis



IF y-axis

Types of AGC

- Simple AGC
- Delayed AGC
- Forward AGC

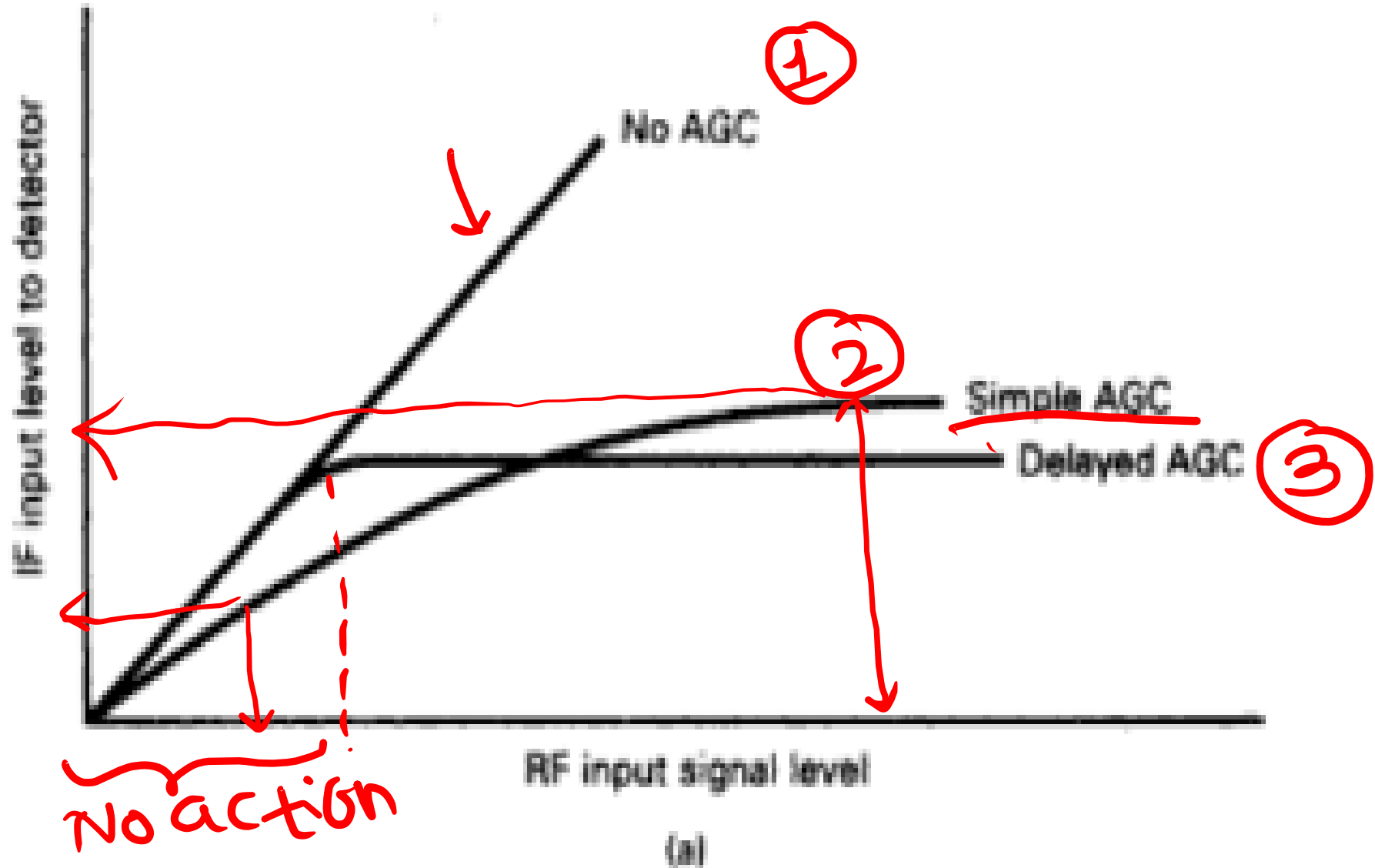
Simple AGC

- The AGC circuit **monitors** the received signal level and sends a **signal back** to the RF and IF amplifiers to adjust their **gain automatically**.
- AGC is a form of **degenerative** or negative feedback.
- The AGC circuit produces a **voltage** that adjusts the receiver gain and keeps the IF carrier power at the input to the **detector constant**.

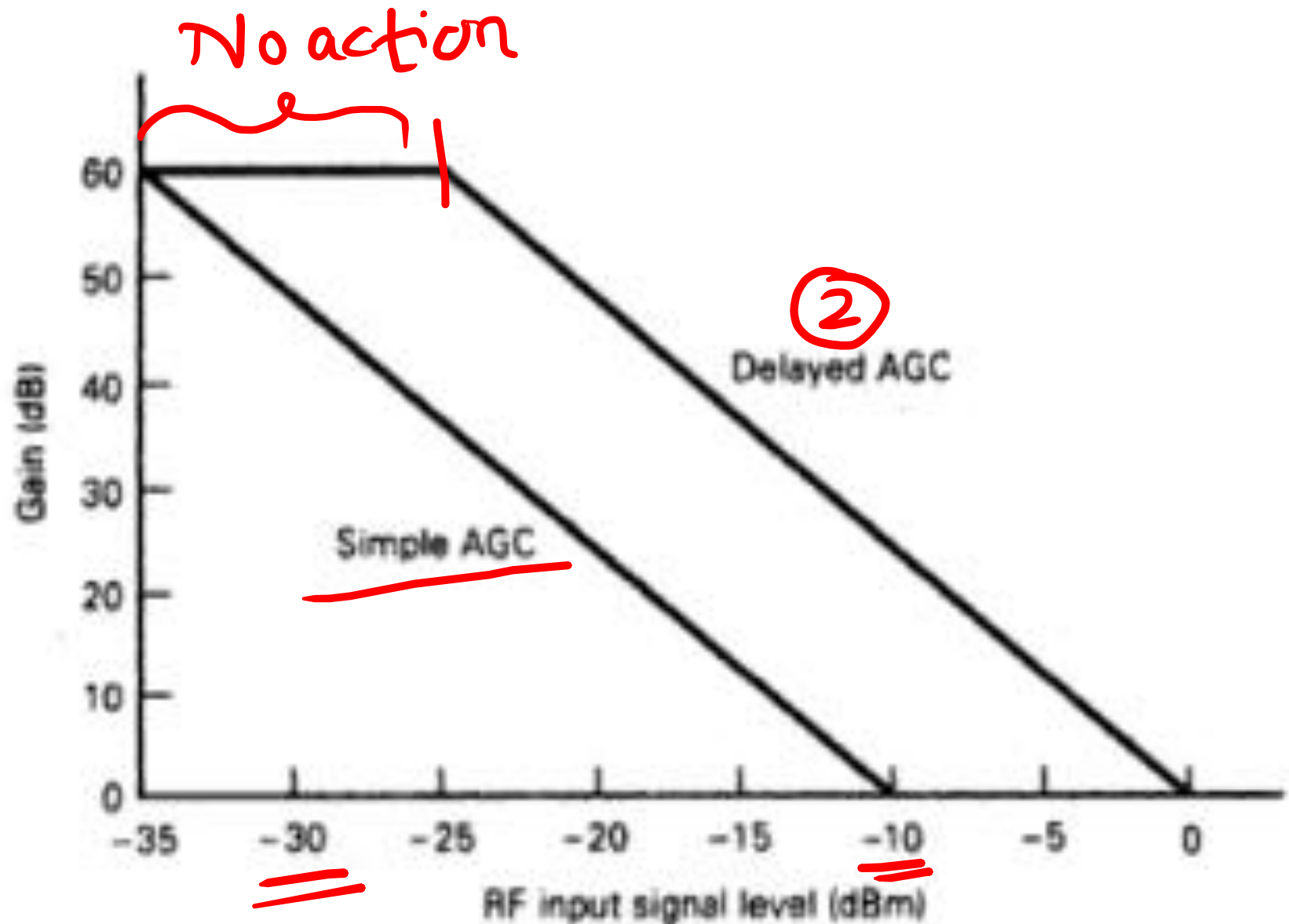
Delayed AGC

- With simple AGC, the AGC bias begins to increase as soon as the **received signal level increases**.
- Leads to **false triggering**, and receiver becomes less sensitive, which is called **automatic desensing**.
- Delayed AGC **prevents feedback** voltage until RF level exceeds a **predetermined magnitude**.
- After AGC **threshold** the output is proportional to carrier signal strength.

AGC Response Characteristics



AGC Response Characteristics



Forward AGC

- Both delayed and simple AGC are post-AGC (after-the-fact) compensation.

- AGC voltage changes indicates that it may be too late.

- In forward AGC the received signal is monitored closer to the front end of the receiver and correction voltage is fed.

Forward AGC

Antenna

